

Technology usually evolves through two pathways – someone “builds” a new technology out of necessity to solve a particular problem, or someone “discovers” an existing technology and finds ways in which it can be used to solve new problems (which the original technology may not have been designed for). Augmented Reality (AR) is one field that owes its evolution to both aspects equally. As new information demands emerged, new ways of adding information to reality were found. Each passing day sees an increasing number of applications of augmented reality, and its potential seems endless. In this chapter, we show you how AR is already modifying our lives in some key areas, and what to expect in the coming years.

Military

Although, the prime motivator behind all innovations in military technology is to make it easier to defeat the enemy and prevent the reverse, several technological breakthroughs do find their way into civilian hands. AR is one such advancement that has significantly increased the success rate for other systems and even military.

Wait a minute! Chances are that you are wondering when was the last time you used AR, and that too as a military application. First person shooter (FPS) games, of course. Most FPS games show some really innovative use of AR: name of buildings, teammates and weapons as you hover the mouse pointer over them, and indicating directions to the next checkpoint without ever having to shift your focus from the screen center.



AR can be very useful in military